Cross-Curricular Centers

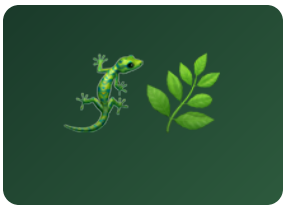
SCIENCE | LITERACY | TECHNOLOGY | SOCIAL STUDIES | DRAMA

SCIENCE CENTER

⏱ 30 MIN

Chameleon Habitat

Tell children to review the chameleon's habitat. Then have them use the natural materials to assemble a mock habitat for a chameleon. Suggest that they cut out flowers and trees from construction paper and cut out a chameleon for the habitat as well, showing how the chameleon blends in with its surroundings. Talk about how blending in with its surroundings might help the chameleon survive.



MATERIALS

- Pupil Edition
- shoe boxes (one per child)
- real leaves and twigs
- sand
- construction paper

LITERACY CENTER

⏱ 15 MIN

Changing Words

Write several initial consonants and blends on different colors of construction paper. Cut out two chameleon shapes from colored acetate. On one cutout write the phonogram -ide. On the other, write -id. Have children place the cutouts on the construction paper with consonants, blends, and digraphs to try different combinations to build and read words. Have children record some of the words they build in their journals.



MATERIALS

- chameleon cutouts from colored acetate
- poster with initial consonants and blends
- Word Building journals
- pencils

TECHNOLOGY CENTER

⏱ 15 MIN

Chameleon Composing

Have children use word processing software to compose sentences at the computer. Encourage them to write sentences to compare how the chameleon in the story is different from a real chameleon. Have children use the spell-check feature of the software.



MATERIALS

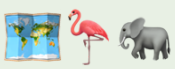
- computer or tablet
- word processing software

SOCIAL STUDIES CENTER

⏱ 30 MIN

Zoo Map

Tell children to review all the animals the chameleon saw at the zoo. Have each child draw a map for an imaginary zoo like the one in the story. Make sure children format their maps on letter and number grids so someone could use the map to find the flamingo pond or the elephant area.



MATERIALS

- construction paper
- crayons or markers
- Pupil Edition

DRAMA CENTER

15 MIN

A Day in the Life of a Chameleon

Give children party blowouts and fly cutouts. Have them use the party blowouts as tongues as they pretend to be chameleons trying to catch flies. Encourage them to engage in dialogue and act out other chameleon behaviors also, such as changing colors.



MATERIALS

- party blowouts (one per child)
- fly cutouts

School–Home Connection

Your child is reading "The Mixed-Up Chameleon" by Eric Carle. Ask your child to tell you about the story. Then have your child use each vocabulary word in a sentence about the story. You can also ask your child to draw a picture of a chameleon and label it with descriptive words from the story.

This Week's Words

dull · exciting · handsome · hardly · sparkling · spotted · sideways